dominance, connectivity not isolation, respect for global commons, inclusive not exclusive mechanisms, and adherence to international rules and norms."[25]

Ram Madhav, the BJP's General Secretary, has been one of the key strategists behind this diplomatic charm offensive, influenced by his party's ideology of integral humanism or Hindu nationalism. He lamented, for example, how "earlier, culture and civilisation had no place in our foreign policy," and underlined that "we are increasing our engagement with other countries and the global community based on our cultural thinking and civilisational ethos."[26] As the director of the India Foundation, Madhav spearheaded multiple international initiatives and outreach, specially focused on South and Southeast Asia, to promote an "Indic" version of soft power.[27] At the policy level, this new drive materialised into a special parliamentary report on "India's Soft Power Diplomacy including role of Indian Council for Cultural Relations (ICCR) and Indian Diaspora," released in 2017 with multiple recommendations.[28]

The second recent trend relates to the *strategic* emphasis placed on Indian governmental definitions of soft power around the concept of pluralism. For states like India, with strong civilisational roots, culture comes in many forms and offers significant potential to achieve strategic objectives. But beyond just sponsoring sporting exchanges or movie festivals abroad, which is the daily bedrock of cultural diplomacy, the Indian government has developed a broader cultural narrative to pursue its interests abroad. Speaking to parliamentarians, S. Jaishankar most cogently defined this multifaceted approach:

> While culture and history are at the centre of this reservoir, there are today many other factors – political, economic and technological – that form part of the mix. There are parts of the world where India is deeply